

STUDY OF SOCIAL MEDIA CONSUMPTION BY AGING POPULATION IN INDIA

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of

Bachelor of Business Administration

by

ABHISHEK KUMAR

22BBA0003

Under the guidance of

Dr. Anil Verma



VIT[®]
Vellore Institute of Technology
(Deemed to be University under section 3 of UGC Act, 1956)
Business School

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DECLARATION

I hereby declare that the capstone project entitled “**Study of social media consumption by aging population in India**” submitted by me, for the award of the degree of **Bachelor of Business Administration** to VIT is a record of Bonafide work carried out by me under the supervision of **Dr. Anil Varma**.

I further declare that the work reported in this thesis has not been submitted and will not be submitted, either part or full, for the award of any other degree or diploma in this institute or any other institute or university.

Place Vellore

Date : 30/04/2025

Signature of the Candidate

CERTIFICATION

This is to certify that the capstone project entitled “**Study of social media consumption by aging population in India**” submitted by **Abhishek Kumar, Reg no 22BBA0003, Business school, Vellore Institute of Technology**, for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Business Administration, is a record of Bonafide work carried out by him under my supervision during the period from 28/04/2025-30/04/2025, as per the VIT code of academic and research ethics.

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External Examiner

Independent Study Title	A STUDY OF SOCIAL MEDIA CONSUMPTION BY AGING POPULATION IN BANGKOK
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ABSTRACT

The number of elderly residents keeps rising in India at a fast pace throughout metropolitan areas including Bengaluru Mumbai and Delhi. More seniors throughout the nation are using social media tools because they offer digital alternatives for staying connected with family members. The purpose of this research investigation aims to understand how Indian seniors perceive social media as well as their usage behaviours. The research study obtained second-hand data about societal patterns together with the patterns of consumer conduct and technological adoption behaviour among senior citizens. Further research involved in-depth conversations that studied senior citizens' perceptive skills and social media usage behaviours together with secondary research data. Researchers distributed a qualitative questionnaire which led to Statistical Package for Social Science (SPSS) processing of the acquired data. Most Indian senior citizens hold positive opinions about social media since they discover it improves their mental health and life quality. The findings recommend the private and public sectors should actively connect with their elderly consumer base on social media by following their behaviour patterns to accomplish efficient communication.

Keywords: Aging population, Indian elderly, social media adoption, Digital inclusion

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction to Research Study

The worldwide population age composition is undergoing swift transformation through aging which leads to higher numbers of elderly people. The demographic shift affects numerous business areas profoundly especially those operating in the digital sector. Young people easily adopt social media, yet research has failed to explain how older adults use these platforms due to their diverse adoption and use patterns. A new study is built to fill this knowledge gap through research into how aging adults use social media platforms (Lian et al., 2022, Nunan & Di, 2019).

Reports show older adults are joining social media platforms more frequently, yet research indicates serious differences with how they use the platforms when compared to younger users. Research has identified three advantages of social media usage for senior adults: preserving social relationships and obtaining information while pursuing non-work-related activities (Bui, 2021, Nunan & Di, 2019). Studies present conflicting findings about challenges which include digital literacy limitations and privacy and security concerns as well as social isolation potentials despite increased digital involvement (Bui, 2021, Lian, 2022 Nunan & Di, 2019, Rajib, 2023). Stakeholders continue to debate the psychological and physiological effects of social media on senior citizens (Kang & Ridgway, 1996).

The research seeks to improve comprehension of social media habits among senior citizens across various essential topics. The investigation probes into the variables which shape their platform selection preferences and their social media engagement purposes along with their activity levels and their evaluated positive and negative online experience outcomes. We will also analyse how social media affects different aspects of wellness by examining social engagement together with mental health and physical health conditions (Bui, 2021, Kang & Ridgway, 1996, Rajib, 2023, Xu, 2021).

Research findings will generate repercussions for social media companies and policymakers as well as marketing organizations who want to better understand and fulfil the requirements of this ever-growing demographic. Social media has become a global phenomenon because of

digital communication growth which has prompted debates about its need among elderly population groups. Aged society requires purposeful planning that covers residential spaces as well as mental health to face its practical difficulties. The quality of life of older adults, together with their ability to handle emotional situations, improves markedly with strong social connections. (Gabriel & Bowling, 2004, Antonucci & Akiyama, 1991). The study draws on “Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)” to demonstrate how users accept computer systems in various technological implementations and demographic settings (Davis et al., 1989). Success in determining user motivation emerges from two fundamental variables according to the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM). Perceived usefulness and 2. Perceived ease of use. Research implementation of the Technology Acceptance Model produces enhanced understanding about how older adults view social media based on its everyday usefulness levels. Research findings from this work will create useful knowledge to improve older adult life quality and mental wellness through identification of digital literacy improvement methods and security minimization techniques for creating meaningful digital activities suited to their needs.

1.2 Research Objectives

The research aims to understand aging consumer attitude and behaviour toward social media consumption. The objectives of this study are listed below:

1. To study aging population’s attitude towards social media consumption.
2. To study aging population’s behaviour towards social media consumption.
3. To identify factors that influence aging populations by using social media.
4. To study aging population’s Intention towards social media consumption.

Key variables of this study are classified as

- 1) Social media aging user’s demographic such as age, education, income and occupation.
- 2) Psychographic variables such as attitude, opinion, interest and lifestyle.
- 3) Aging population behaviour such as average time spent and purpose of use.

Qualitative and quantitative methodologies were used to collect secondary and primary data for this study. Target respondents are seniors who are 60 years old, currently use social media and live in India.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

This section explains the relevant studies, research, articles and academic journals that are related to behaviour and technology adoption for aging populations.

2.1 Aging Consumer

Consumers aged above 65 years are growing more important because demographic changes toward older people drive purchasing patterns and market structures to evolve. The already-defined preferences of senior consumers often weaken competitiveness thereby leading to higher prices as well as slower economic growth (Bres & Angelini, 2025). The United States experienced a GDP growth reduction of 8.7% during 1995 to 2004 but the advancing baby boomer generation led to a growth increase of 10.3% from 2005 to 2019 (Bres & Angelini, 2025). Fashion companies have begun to recognize older consumers as key customers since many perceive brands focus on younger demographics (Kang & Ju, 2025; Ju & Kang, 2025). Integrated marketing strategies from Gap Inc. and J. CREW recognize older customers as the new industry norm according to Kang and Ju (2025). The aging process affects how people think and make decisions so older shoppers occasionally perform unexpected purchasing behaviours (Wang, 2024). Companies must develop marketing approaches specific to their behaviour because psychological elements heavily affect their purchasing behaviours (Zheng et al., 2024).

2.2 Social Relationships

The quality of one's social relationships is crucial for health and well-being since they directly impact physical health as well as brain operation and total life satisfaction. Research evidence demonstrates that strong social ties bring health protection, develop better memory abilities, and boost emotional happiness in people. Social isolation leads to elevated inflammation along with heart disease, but positive relationships serve as protective factors by decreasing these health issues (Ragab et al., 2024). The connection strength between older adults and their social network directly influences their dental health according to research findings (Yoshida-Kohn et al., 2024). The research shows social relationships help older adults improve their memory and thinking capacity though scientists think this positive influence weakens through time (Vogel et al., 2024). Social support serves as a fundamental factor that enhances the quality of

life of individuals who are healing from severe medical conditions. Breast cancer survivors who receive reliable social support end up having enhanced health and well-being while recovering, according to Belau et al. (2024).

2.3 Technology Adoption

Business performance enhancement through technology adoption remains a complex procedure which functions as an essential factor in various industries. Businesses need to protect their existing capabilities yet seek new technological advances which will maintain their competitive edge. Businesses should evaluate the worth of technological investments by considering their current requirements and potential upcoming possibilities (Badiru, 2019). Through proper management of new technologies organizations can both deal with uncertain situations and generate better revenues (Badiru, 2019). Technology helps the public sector deliver enhanced government services through increased process efficiency when interacting with citizens (Rekunen et al., 2025). The success of new initiatives depends on both strong leaderships together with intuitive designs but past systems limitations and change resistance act as roadblocks (Rekunen et al., 2025). Technology usage by small businesses leads to profitability growth along with competitive advantages through energy-efficient solutions (Gupta et al., 2024). The expenditure for advanced technology presents a challenge for businesses because they must thoroughly evaluate their predicted return on investment according to Gupta et al. (2024). People's acceptance of new systems is influenced by their opinions about technology because the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) demonstrates that user-friendly systems with practical features attract more users (Or, 2024). The adoption rate increases when people embrace technology positively (Or, 2024). Companies like Dangote must undergo digital transformation to remain competitive in the market because digital platforms allowed them to embrace technical advancements (Temitope, 2025). Proper training and digital skills improvement act as essential elements to address challenges and establish innovative company culture (Temitope, 2025).

2.4 Social Media

Through social media people now interact differently across agriculture and psychology in addition to maintaining their community connections. The usage of social media in Nepalese developing nations assists experts in agriculture to transfer agricultural information to farmers alongside advancing farming innovations among the agricultural community. The problems

stem from misdirected information and insufficient internet connection. Through social media users can establish connections and participate in communities since real-time interactions and collaborative possibilities are available (Meikle, 2023). Social media enhances professional resource sharing which leads to better performance in extension services ("Social Media," 2022). Aside from the sphere of communication social media creates effective changes which directly impact human mental health and social behaviours patterns ("Social Media," 2022). Social media has transformed human communication according to researchers in language and anthropology thus demanding fresh interpretations of these behavioural changes (Calhoun, 2022). Social media platforms come with risks that permit destructive practices including the sexual abuse of children ("Social Media," 2023). Social media problems with misleading information and unequal digital resource availability block people mainly in developing nations ("Social Media," 2022).

2.5 Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)

TAM represents a vital conceptual structure which helps scientists understand why users accept new technological systems. Throughout the course of its development in 1986 Fred Davis established PEOU and PU as fundamental drivers in the Technology Acceptance Model. Users decide to accept and maintain use of technology based on these factors. TAM serves as an essential model that healthcare and gaming industries together with banking employ to analyse user behaviours and enhance technology adoption rates. Some experts suggest modifying the model because it does not fit all situations effectively. People decide to accept new technology based on how easy they judge the system to be. Medical staff utilize Electronic Medical Records (EMR) with greater frequency when they discover the system to be easily navigated according to Shania & Paramarta (2024). Long-term application of PU becomes vital for sustained engagement as people in banking continue to use digital banking applications because these tools prove helpful and efficient (Sawa et al., 2024). Researchers agree that Attitude Toward Using (ATU) serves as a connection between PEOU, PU and the user intent to adopt new technologies (Or, 2024). TAM exists as a useful concept that scientists have utilized throughout multiple industry fields. The acceptance of Electronic Medical Record systems depends on user experiences with ease of use and usefulness because they both positively affect patient satisfaction according to Shania & Paramarta (2024). Steam with its variations in user reception follows market plans and system functionality (Mahendra et al., 2024) like Epic Games Store. The customer experience assessment of Livin by Bank Mandiri

depends on TAM to show that better benefits and enhanced usability need ongoing improvement (Sawa et al., 2024).

2.6 Senior Technology Acceptance and Adoption model (STAM)

The Senior Technology Acceptance Model (STAM) expands Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) for studying senior citizens' adoption and utilization of new technology systems through their user experience. Research investigates the ways senior citizens experience and feel about smart home systems and social robots. STAM determines the important elements that include perceived ease of use (PEOU) and perceived usefulness while recognizing social influences from caregivers and members of the family and the supporting benefits of training programs. Research demonstrates older people will adopt technology when the benefits to their daily lives are evident especially through key aspects such as safety improvements and health benefits alongside social connections. The adoption of technology faces obstacles because older adults often experience technophobia and have restricted digital literacy skills (Wang et al., 2024; Zhengkun et al., 2025; Cai, 2024; Tan, 2024). The usefulness of STAM extends to numerous technology studies and future research must work to resolve ongoing obstacles.

2.7 Attitude

People develop attitudes through three components which include mental thoughts (cognitive), emotional feelings (affective), and actual behaviours (behavioural) regarding varied people, products, or concepts (Wolf et al., 2020). These thoughts assist us in decision-making processes and value declaration and social connection (Briñol et al., 2019). Surveys serve as one approach to measure attitudes while automatic response observation constitutes another method. People who hold positive attitudes in their workplace experience better job satisfaction alongside increased motivation which contributes to enhanced job performance. Companies create better employee satisfaction when they implement both high compensation and opportunities for career advancement (Cabrera & Estacio, 2022). The science field requires students to keep their minds open to new evidence which might require changes in their beliefs (Murugan, 2019). Professional library operations achieve better customer satisfaction through positive attitudes which in turn leads to excellent service delivery (Maulana & Nurhayani, 2023). The impact of attitudes on behaviour remains unclear since human personality and situational factors along with conscious and automatic attitudes determine our responses (Briñol et al., 2019).

H1: Attitudes have a significant relationship with intention.

H2: Attitudes have a significant relationship with Actual sharing behaviour.

2.8 Subjective Norms

Subjective norms, which refer to the social pressures individuals feel to behave in a certain way, play a powerful role in shaping human actions across various aspects of life. These pressures often stem from close circles such as friends, family, and influential members of the community. In romantic relationships, for instance, individuals may feel compelled to commit or remain in a relationship based on what they believe is expected by those around them, as Etcheverry and Agnew (2004) suggest. Early trust in such relationships is also guided by these norms, although over time, people shift their focus to observing tangible behaviour's rather than relying solely on social expectations (Jeffries, 2016). Subjective norms also influence prosocial behaviour, such as charitable donations, especially among individuals who are naturally empathetic or generous, as they may feel greater pressure to conform to socially valued acts like giving (Susanto et al., 2022). In the agricultural sector, farmers are more likely to adopt innovative technologies when they receive encouragement and support from family members, local leaders, or respected peers in the community (Baba et al., 2023). Similarly, in culturally distinct societies like matrilineal communities, decisions such as starting a business are heavily influenced by what is considered acceptable or encouraged within the social structure (Marbaniang & Rajput, 2023). Overall, subjective norms are deeply embedded in everyday life and significantly impact individual choices, demonstrating how societal expectations continue to influence behaviours in both personal and collective settings.

H3: Subjective Norms have a significant relationship with intention.

H4: Subjective Norms have a significant relationship with Actual sharing behaviour.

2.9 Intention.

The study of intention exists within multiple spheres of knowledge which includes philosophy together with law both alongside literature and religion. According to phenomenology and philosophy intention represents a mental view of direction and focus on the targets of our thinking and acting (Meyers, 2023). The theory serves as a means of explaining human-driven purposes and intentions. The law defines intention as the state where somebody decides mentally to produce a specific result for legal responsibility assessments of criminal defendants (Siraganian, 2025; Simionescu, 2012). Within literary theory researchers examine intention through analysis of authors' underlying intentions which appear in their written works (Siraganian, 2025). The origins of the intention concept stem from Medieval Scholastic philosophy as a historical development. Through the term "intentio animi" Augustine and others presented their view that the human mind can voluntarily steer attention and create plans for action (Parisi, 2023). Religious interpretations mainly observed in Buddhism demonstrate how intention directly influences human conduct and the creation of karma. In the context of moral actions Buddhism has two terms *saṅkappa* and *cetanā* which express various intention elements that propel moral actions (Meyers, 2023). The idea of intention traces its beginnings into deep historical and cultural backgrounds. According to medieval scholars Saint Augustine documented mental direction as the basic understanding of intention during this period (Parisi, 2023). The Buddhist view presents two related terms *saṅkappa* and *cetanā* that describe both spiritual and moral dimensions of intention as it impacts karma (Meyers, 2023).

H5: Intention has a significant relationship with Actual sharing behaviour.

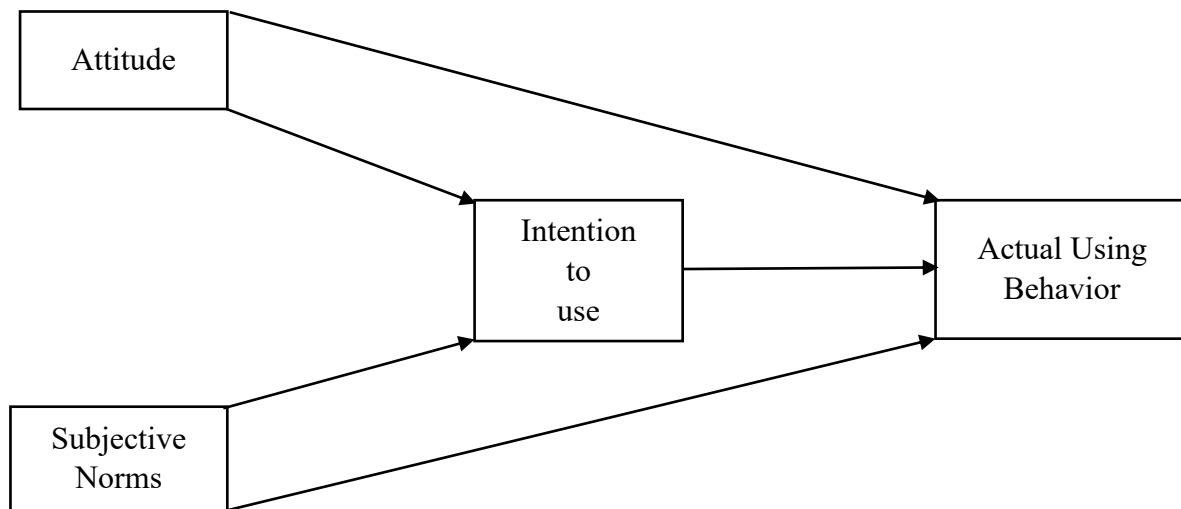
H6: Intention has a significant mediates relationship with Attitude and Actual sharing behaviour.

H7: Intention has a significant mediates relationship with Subjective Norms and Actual sharing behaviour.

2.10 Conceptual Framework and Path Analysis

The study suggests a conceptual framework and path analysis (Figure 1 and 2) using Theory of Planned Behaviour to examine social media consumption by aging population in India. Key elements such as attitude, subjective norms, & perceived behavioural control influence the intention to use social media, the latter being used. It also considers the part that demographic variables such as age and digital literacy play in these relationships.

Figure 1 Framework



Source 1Compiled by Author

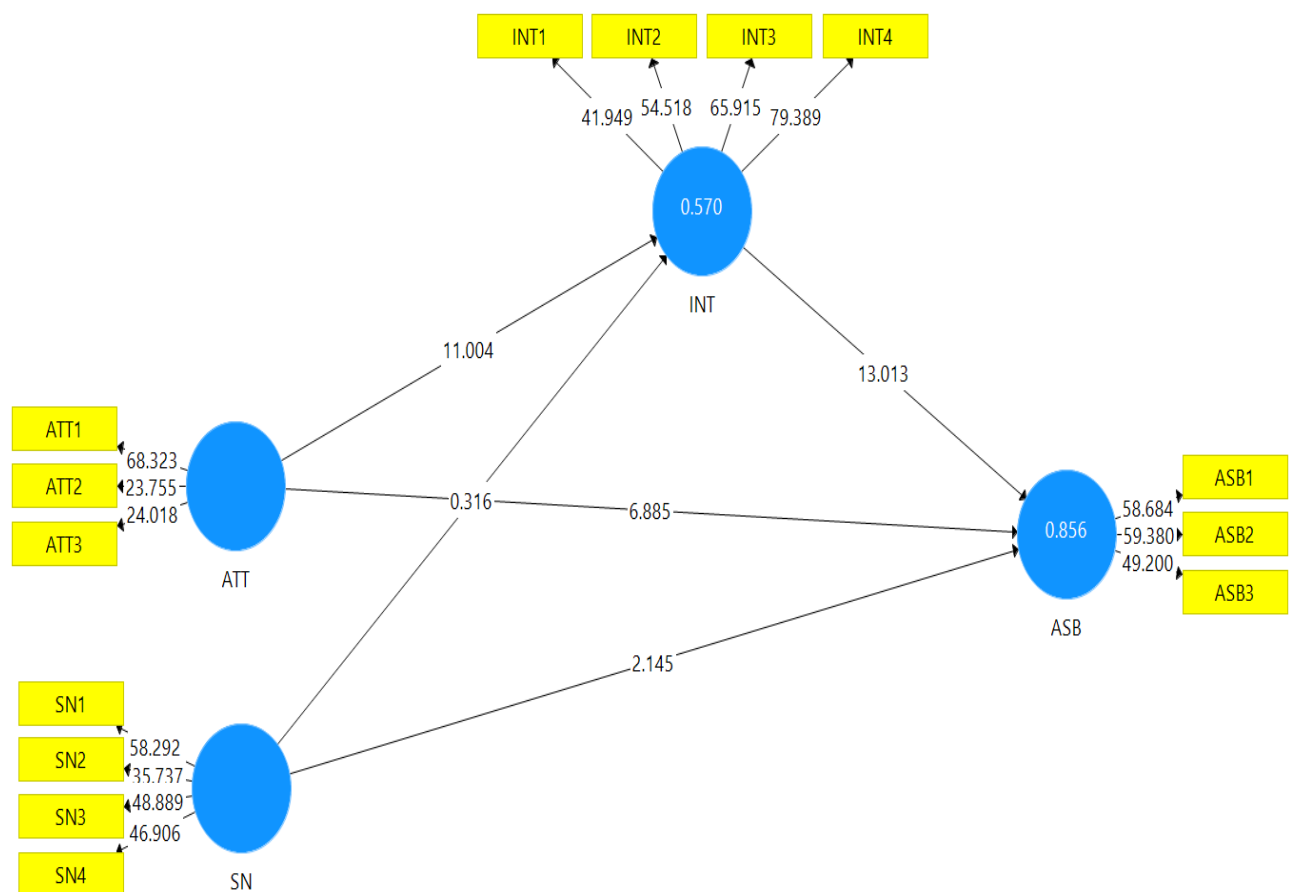


Figure 2 Path Analysis

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH AND METHODOLOGY

3.1 Exploratory Research

The study implements both quantitative and qualitative research methods. Several qualitative methods were used in exploratory research to gather primary information for developing descriptive research.

3.1.1 Secondary Data Research

Background information for the study was obtained through secondary research methods. The study extracted its information by evaluating published literature and previous research findings instead of performing fieldwork with participants. The main target of this research was to understand four fundamental topics: society's overall organization along with its lifestyles, consumer conduct patterns, social connection dynamics between individuals and the way digital platforms and social media platforms evolve and shape modern life habits. The research gathered information through authorized sources containing published research papers along with academic journals and government reports and other scholarly materials found online. The research foundations became stronger through this process because it established patterns and supported questionnaire development and kept the study consistent with established theoretical frameworks and previous research outcomes.

3.2 Descriptive Research

The survey was disseminated through the online tool Google Forms. The link to the form was dispersed through social media platforms such as LinkedIn and WhatsApp to expand your audience and primarily to caters towards the older adults residing in diverse locales in India. It was also distributed in cities such as Mumbai, Delhi, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, and Bangalore. The questionnaire was shared both online and offline and through personal networks. To ensure the right participants, screening questions were used to confirm that respondents were social media users aged 50 and above living in India. The measurement levels of the questionnaire were revised and amended from the previous validated research. Items regarded attentiveness, way of being norms, perceived action manageability were adjusted based on Ajzen's Theory of Planned Behaviour (1991). Items related to social media use were adapted from prior studies

measuring Nigerian digital behaviour among older adults. A five-point Likert scale was applied to every variable and responses ran from Disagree (1) to Agree (5). These scales were utilised as they are congruent with the constructs and variables studied in this research.

3.2.1 Survey Questionnaire

As research methods, questionnaire survey was adopted in this study. Judgmental sampling occurred and the language of the inquiry was English. The intended structured survey was based on the Theory of Planned Behaviour (TPB) and comprised of four main parts:

- Questions on Attitude toward Social Media Use
- Questions on Subjective Norms
- Questions on Perceived Behavioural Control
- Demographic Information of the respondents

3.3 Sampling Plan

207 respondents completed online and offline questionnaires. Before the main survey, a pilot test was conducted with 12 participants to ensure the questionnaire was clear, logical, and easy to understand. This also helped determine the time required for completion and minimize potential errors.

3.3.1 Sampling Selection Criteria

- Gender: Both male and female
- Age: 50 years old and above
- Location: India
- Current social media user

CHAPTER 4

DATA ANALYSIS AND RESULT

The data sets were studied by using SPSS version 20.0 and Smart-PLS version 3.3.3. At the time of analysis two number items have been removed that is E3 and P3, those two items were negative questions kept for analysing the respondent accuracy.

The participants in this research are Indian older adults who are Full-time employed, part-time employed, Retired and Housewife. The survey was circulated through a web-based application like LinkedIn and what's app group, from the above platform total of 207 sets of reliable data were received. After the screening of data, all the data are valid records.

4.1 According to 207 respondents, Table 1 displays that the majority of representative samples of the aging population are Male (58.5%). Only 41.5% of them are Female respondents. Furthermore, it shows that the majority earned degree of education, bachelor's degree (45.5 %). In profession, 54.1% of respondents are retired, while 20.3% and 8.7% are full-time and part-time employed, respectively. In addition, 94.2% of them are staying with family, while 5.8% are living alone. Most of the aging population in this study have two children (40.6%) and have grandchildren (42%). When classified them by using household income per month, most of them earned 50,001-100,000 (34.8) and more than 100,000 (34.8%).

Table I Respondent Demographic Profile

	Demographic	Frequency	Percent (%)
Gender	Female	86	41.5%
	Male	121	58.5%
Education Level	Lower than primary school	5	2.4%
	Primary school	5	2.4%
	High school	68	32.9%
	Bachelor's degree	94	45.5%
	Master's degree	33	15.9%
	Other	2	0.9%

Current Occupation	Full-time employed	42	20.3%
	Part-time employed	18	8.7%
	Retired	112	54.1%
	Housewife	33	15.9%
	Other	1	0.5%
Marital Status	Alone	12	5.8%
	Live with family	195	94.2%
	Others	0	0.0%
Number of Children	0	3	1.4%
	1	18	8.7%
	2	84	40.6%
	3	81	39.1%
	4 or above	21	10.1%
Number of Grandchildren	0	29	14.0%
	1	36	17.4%
	2	87	42.0%
	3	45	21.7%
	4 or above	10	4.8%
Household Income/Month	Less than 15,000 INR	11	5.3%
	15,001 – 30,000 INR	14	6.8%
	30,001 – 50,000 INR	38	18.4%
	50,001 – 100,000 INR	72	34.8%
	More than 100,000 INR	72	34.8%

4.2 Outer loadings

To establish a robust outer measurement model, it is expected that the factor loadings for all components should approach or exceed the suggested threshold of 0.7. The present evaluation was conducted using the scholarly contributions of Chin, Peterson, and Brown (2008) and Hair, J.F. (2013). After carefully examining the individual outer loadings, it was determined that the outer model showed only a limited level of acceptability.

Table II Outer loadings

	Actual Using Behaviour	Attitude	Intention	Subjective Norms
AUB1	0.889			
AUB2	0.896			
AUB3	0.888			
ATT1		0.854		
ATT2		0.815		
ATT3		0.833		
INT1			0.873	
INT2			0.875	
INT3			0.898	
INT4			0.904	
SN1				0.888
SN2				0.827
SN3				0.899
SN4				0.874

4.3 Factor Analysis

Kaiser Meyer Olkin (KMO) measures sampling adequacy, which determines if the replies provided with the sample are sufficient or not. For factor analysis to proceed satisfactorily, the KMO value should be close to 0.5. According to Kaiser (1974), values for KMO should be at least 0.5 (just acceptable), between 0.7 and 0.8 (acceptable), and beyond 0.9 (excellent). Looking at table II below, the KMO score is 0.956, which is quite acceptable.

As per Kaiser (1974), the significance level for Bartlett's test below .05 is suggested, looking at table II below, Bartlett's test is 0.000, and therefore by looking at factor analysis we can conclude that there is a substantial co-relationship in the data.

Table III KMO and Bartlett's Test

Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin Measure of Sampling Adequacy.		.956
Bartlett's Test of Sphericity	Approx. Chi-Square	2076.302
	df	28
	Sig.	0.000

4.4 Fornell-Larcker Criterion (Pearson Correlation)

The Fornell-Larcker Criterion was used to assess discriminant validity among the constructs in the Theory of Planned Behaviour model, specifically Attitude (ATT), Subjective Norms (SN), Intention (INT), and Actual Using Behaviour (AUB). According to Bonett and Wright (2000), the Pearson correlation evaluates the strength of the relationship between two variables, with values ranging from -1 to +1. A value close to +1 indicates a strong positive correlation, 0 indicates no correlation, and -1 indicates a strong negative correlation. The square root of the Average Variance Extracted (AVE) for each construct (shown on the diagonal) was greater than the inter-construct correlations, indicating good discriminant validity (Table IV).

Table IV Fornell-Larcker Criterion

	Actual Using Behaviour	Attitude	Intention	Subjective Norms
Actual Using Behaviour	0.891			
Attitude	0.831	0.834		
Intention	0.890	0.754	0.887	
Subjective Norms	0.564	0.744	0.549	0.873

Table V Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT)

	Actual Using Behaviour	Attitude	Intention	Subjective Norms
Actual Using Behaviour				
Attitude	0.849			
Intention	0.880	0.857		
Subjective Norms	0.638	0.811	0.608	

4.5 Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT)

It is also noteworthy that all HTMT values were consistently below the 0.9 threshold, affirming discriminant validity. The study meets the discriminant validity requirements specified by Fornell and Larcker (1981) and adheres to the HTMT criterion proposed by Hair et al. (2017).

4.6 Model Fit

According to Hair et al. (2014), for the model to be free of multicollinearity problems, the collinearity statistics, or Variance Inflated Factor (VIF), must be 5.0 or lower. Table IV below demonstrates that the Variance Inflated Factor (VIF) is less than 5.0. The outcome then demonstrates that the various model fit files meet the advised standardized standards and shows that the examination model suggested in this investigation or research provides the best match to the data acquired. Where Items refers to the precise number of survey questions used. Theory of Planned Behaviour, including Attitude (ATT), Subjective Norms (SN), Intention (INT), and Actual Using Behaviour (AUB).

Table VI Variance Inflated Factor **VIF**

Items	VIF
AUB1	2.324
AUB2	2.426
AUB3	2.175
ATT1	1.426
ATT2	1.909
ATT3	1.996
INT1	2.499
INT2	2.498
INT3	3.035
INT4	3.155
SN1	2.628
SN2	2.048
SN3	3.033
SN4	2.644

4.7 Reliability and Convergent Validity

The loading indicator's concealed structures should be more than 0.70, according to Gefen et al. (2003). In contrast, the loading factor indicator that is lower than 0.4 must be removed. This demonstrated that the reliability indicators in this study are greater than 0.7, as shown in table V, which also shows that Cronbach's alpha is greater than 0.7.

The composite reliability (CR) should be more than 0.7, according to Gefen et al. Table V shows the supporting data for the composite reliability's exclusive steadiness measurement model, which is larger than 0.7.

An evaluation of Average Variance Extracted (AVE) was completed with the assurance to analyse the link of indicators with its hidden constructions. According to Hair et al. (2014), AVE reveals the extent to which a hidden concept explains the inconsistent behaviour of its indicator. To accomplish palatable blended validity, each construct needs to mean more prominent than half of the selected indicators' variance ($AVE > 0.50$). The AVE esteem for each of the buildings is greater than 50%, as shown in Table V.

Table VII Reliability and Convergent Validity

	Cronbach's Alpha	rho_A	Composite Reliability	Average Variance Extracted (AVE)
Actual Using Behaviour	0.870	0.871	0.920	0.794
Attitude	0.790	0.833	0.873	0.696
Intention	0.910	0.910	0.937	0.787
Subjective Norms	0.895	0.897	0.927	0.761

4.8 Hypothesis Testing

In this study, the acceptance of hypotheses is based on the criteria that T statistics should be greater than 1.645 and the probability (p) value should be less than 0.05, indicating statistical significance. However, aligning with Hair et al. (2014), a more rigorous threshold suggests that T statistics should exceed 2.33 and p-values should be below 0.01 for strong significance. Table VII provides evidence that several hypotheses fulfil the minimum requirement for statistical significance, as their T statistics exceed 1.645 and p-values are under 0.05. Additionally, a number of these hypotheses also meet the more stringent benchmark, demonstrating T statistics above 2.33 and p-values below 0.01. This distinction enables a clearer understanding of the robustness of the findings, where hypotheses meeting the stricter criteria can be interpreted as having stronger empirical support. As such, Table VII not only confirms the significance of key relationships but also differentiates between moderately and strongly supported results, enhancing the overall validity and depth of the analysis.

The following findings were derived: **Path coefficient**

- **T statistics-value = 6.885, Probability-value = 0.000**, Attitude (ATT) has a positive relationship with Actual using Behaviour (AUB), hence **H1 is accepted**.
- **T statistics-value = 11.004, Probability-value = 0.000**, Attitude (ATT) has a positive relationship with Intention (INT), hence **H2 is accepted**.
- **T statistics-value = 2.145, Probability-value = 0.032**, Social Norms (SN) have a negative relationship with Actual using Behaviour (AUB), hence **H3 is accepted**.
- **T statistics-value = 0.316, Probability-value = 0.752**, Social Norms (SN) do not significantly influence Intention (INT), hence **H4 is not accepted**.
- **T statistics-value = 13.013, Probability-value = 0.000**, Intention (INT) has a positive relationship with Actual using Behaviour (AUB), hence **H5 is accepted**.

Mediation Analysis

- **T statistics-value = 8.012, Probability-value = 0.000**, Intention (INT) mediates the relationship between Attitude (ATT) and Actual Using Behaviour (AUB), hence **H6 is accepted**.

- **T statistics-value = 0.320, Probability-value = 0.749**, Intention (INT) does not mediate the relationship between Social Norms (SN) and Actual Using Behaviour (AUB), hence **H7 is not accepted**.

Table VIII Hypothesis Testing Path coefficient

SL NO	Hypothesis	Original Sample (O)	Sample Mean (M)	Standard Deviation (STDEV)	T Statistics (O/STDEV)	P Values	Decision
H1	Attitude (ATT) → Actual Using Behaviour (AUB)	0.450	0.452	0.065	6.885	0.000	Significant
H2	Attitude (ATT) → Intention (INT)	0.775	0.778	0.070	11.004	0.000	Significant
H3	Social Norms (SN) → Actual Using Behaviour (AUB)	-0.104	-0.101	0.049	2.145	0.032	Significant
H4	Social Norms (SN) → Intention (INT)	-0.027	-0.030	0.087	0.316	0.752	Insignificant
H5	Intention (INT) → Actual Using Behaviour (AUB)	0.608	0.603	0.047	13.013	0.000	Significant

Mediation Analysis

SL NO	Hypothesis	Original Sample (O)	Sample Mean (M)	Standard Deviation (STDEV)	T Statistics (O/STDEV)	P Values	Decision
H6	ATT → INT → AUB (Mediation by Intention)	0.471	0.469	0.059	8.012	0.000	Significant
H7	SN → INT → AUB (Mediation by Intention)	-0.017	-0.018	0.052	0.320	0.749	Insignificant

Discussion

The results of the hypothesis testing and mediation analysis reveal that Attitude (ATT) plays a central and influential role in shaping both Intention (INT) and Actual Using Behaviour (AUB). The findings support five out of the seven hypotheses. Specifically, H1 and H2 confirm that ATT has a significant positive relationship with both AUB and INT, indicating that individuals with a favourable attitude are more likely to develop stronger intentions and follow through with actual usage behaviour. Furthermore, H5 demonstrates that INT itself significantly influences AUB, emphasizing the importance of intention as a driving force behind behavioral execution.

The mediation analysis further strengthens these findings. H6 confirms that INT mediates the relationship between ATT and AUB, highlighting a strong indirect pathway from attitude to behaviour via intention. This suggests that while attitude alone can influence behaviour, its effect is magnified when it fosters intention, making it a powerful factor in behavioral models.

In contrast, Social Norms (SN) were found to have a minimal and somewhat inconsistent impact. Although H3 reveals a weak but statistically significant negative relationship between SN and AUB, indicating a slight deterrent effect of social pressure, H4 was not supported. This means SN does not significantly influence INT, and H7 confirms that there is no mediation effect through INT between SN and AUB. These results suggest that social norms may not be an effective factor in influencing intention or behaviour in this context.

4.9 R square and q square

The model's predictive relevance was ascertained using the R-squared and Q-squared values in Table 7. Constructs such as ITU and Perceived Value reported high values of 0.475 and 0.598 for R Square and 0.561 and 0.582 for Q Square, respectively, underlining our model's strong predictive relevance in line with the guidelines from Shmueli et al. (2019).

Table IX R square and q square

	R Square	Q²
Actual Using Behaviour	0.856	0.688
Intention	0.570	0.558

4.10 F-Square Effect Sizes

The F-squared values were assessed to determine the impact of each exogenous latent variable on endogenous constructs, following the recommendations of Cohen (1988) and Hair et al. (2019). The results are presented in Table X. The paths from ATT → AUB, ATT → INT, and INT → AUB, although statistically significant ($p < 0.05$), demonstrated no practical effect size, indicating minimal contribution to the variance of the dependent constructs. In contrast, SN → AUB and SN → INT displayed large effect sizes, underscoring the strong influence of subjective norms on both actual system behaviour and intention. These findings suggest that social influence plays a critical role in shaping user behaviours within the model.

Table X F-Square

	P Values	
Attitude (ATT) → Actual Using Behaviour (ASB)	0.002	No effect
Attitude (ATT) → Intention (INT)	0.000	No effect
Intention (INT) → Actual Using Behaviour (ASB)	0.000	No effect
Subjective Norm (SN) → Actual System Behaviour (ASB)	0.318	Large Effect
Subjective Norm (SN) → Intention (INT)	0.952	Large Effect

CHAPTER 5

5.1 Findings

This study used a theory called the Theory of Planned Behaviour (TPB) to understand how older adults in India use social media. The theory helped explain how three main things—attitude, social pressure (subjective norms), and intention—influence the actual use of social media by the elderly.

The results showed that attitude plays a very important role. Older people who have a positive attitude towards social media are more likely to develop the intention to use it and actually end up using it regularly. This means if seniors feel social media is useful and easy to use, they are more likely to try and continue using it.

Another key finding is that intention acts like a bridge between attitude and behaviour. In other words, when seniors have a positive attitude, it leads to a stronger intention to use social media, and that intention then leads to real action. So, intention is a very important step in turning interest into actual usage.

On the other hand, subjective norms, which are the social pressures from family or society, have a very small or even negative effect. The study found that older adults are not much influenced by what others think when it comes to using social media. Their usage depends more on their personal motivation and comfort with the platform than on social pressure.

The study also highlighted that digital literacy and user-friendly design are important for encouraging social media use among the elderly. If platforms are easy to understand and helpful in daily life, older adults are more likely to use them. Social media was also found to improve mental well-being and help older people stay socially connected, reducing feelings of loneliness.

5.2 Conclusion

This study aims to explore how social media is consumed by the aging population in India and what factors influence their behaviour and intention toward usage. The study shows that key variables—particularly attitude and intention—positively influence the actual social media usage among older adults. This outcome aligns with the idea that a positive attitude leads to

higher engagement with digital platforms, thereby improving quality of life and mental well-being.

Secondly, the study confirms that intention significantly mediates the relationship between attitude and actual usage, highlighting its crucial role in predicting behaviour. However, previous studies have mostly focused on general technology adoption models without emphasizing the behavioural pathway from attitude to action in elderly users.

Thirdly, the study illustrates that subjective norms have a minimal or even negative impact on actual social media usage and do not significantly influence intention. This suggests that older adults' social media habits are less dependent on social pressure and more driven by personal motivation and perceived usefulness.

Hence, it can be concluded that intention serves as a strong mediating factor between attitude and social media use, while subjective norms do not have a mediating role. This emphasizes the need for digital literacy programs and user-friendly platform designs that enhance perceived ease and value, catering to the growing elderly demographic in India's digital space.

5.3 Research Contribution and practical Implication

This study applies the Theory of Planned Behaviour (TPB) to understand the social media consumption patterns of the aging population in India by examining key constructs such as attitude, intention, and subjective norms. The research highlights how **attitude and intention** are major driving forces behind actual social media usage, while **subjective norms** have limited influence. This contributes to existing literature by offering a focused analysis on the elderly demographic, a group often overlooked in digital behaviour studies.

The results of the study can help **policy makers, digital platform designers, and marketers** to craft age-inclusive strategies. For instance, designing social media platforms that emphasize **ease of use and perceived usefulness** can enhance older adults' intrinsic motivation. Public and private institutions can implement training programs to boost digital literacy and engagement, especially by simplifying user interfaces and offering community-driven learning modules.

5.3 Suggestions

The **study suggests** that promoting a **positive attitude and intention** toward social media use will not only improve mental well-being but also strengthen social connectedness among the elderly. Therefore, the findings can be practically applied to enhance both the **quality of life and digital inclusion** of India's aging population, thereby supporting national goals related to active aging and digital empowerment.

5.4 Limitation and Future Research

First, this study primarily focused on a limited set of variables—namely attitude, subjective norms, intention, and actual usage behaviour—based on the Theory of Planned Behaviour. Future research can incorporate additional psychological or technological factors, such as perceived ease of use, digital anxiety, or emotional well-being, to offer a more comprehensive understanding of social media usage among older adults.

Secondly, the study was geographically confined to India, which may limit the generalizability of the results. Future studies can be conducted in other countries or regions to compare cultural and social differences in elderly social media adoption and usage behaviour.

Additionally, the study employed a judgmental sampling technique, which may not fully capture the diversity of the aging population across India. Future research could adopt random or stratified sampling methods to enhance data reliability and representation.

Lastly, while this study used a quantitative approach supported by exploratory interviews, future research can benefit from more longitudinal or experimental designs to observe behavioural trends over time or to test the impact of specific digital interventions targeted at elderly users.

CHAPTER 6

6.1 Reference

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ANNEXURES

SURVEY QUESTIONNAIRE

Appendix

Part A: Screening question

This part will be identified respondent profile

A1. Where do you live?

- ☐ India
- ☐ Other >> End questionnaire

A2. Age

- ☐ Lower than 50 years old >> End
- ☐ 50-60 years old
- ☐ 60 70 years old
- ☐ 80 years old and above

A3. Do you use social

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No >> End

Part B: Behaviour towards social media

B1. What type of social media do you use? (Check all that

- ☐ Facebook
- ☐ Instagram
- ☐ Twitte
- ☐ LinkedIn
- ☐ Snapchat
- ☐ Other (please specify) _____

B2. What kind of communication tools do you use? (Check all that

- ☐ Normal phone (Can only call and SMS
- ☐ Smart phone (A smartphone is a cellular telephone with an integrated computer and

other features not originally associated with telephones, such as an operating system, web browsing and the ability to run software applications.)

- ☐ Tablet
- ☐ Computer
- ☐ Other _____

B3. In a day, what is your average time spent with social media?

____(hour)_____

B4. Please read following statements and mark [X] on the best answer according to your opinion

Statement	Always (1)	Often (2)	Occasionally (3)	Rarely (4)	Never (5)
I use social media to contact with family, cousin, friends, etc.					
I use social media to update news					
I use social media to read product review					
I use social media to update trend					
I use social media for work					
I lost my personal story/photo on social media such as Facebook					
I interact with what friend share on social media					

Part C

What do you do in your free time?

(Check all that apply)

Reading book

- ☐ Exercising
- ☐ Meeting friends
- ☐ Café hopping
- ☐ Planting
- ☐ Shopping
- ☐ Traveling
- ☐ Other: _____

Part D: Attitude towards social media consumption

Statement	Strongly agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly disagree
Social media help me to contact with family easily Social media help me to contact with friends easily Social media help me to connect with old friends Social media can connect the world social media can reduce gap in family among different generations I don't feel alone anymore when I use social media It is convenience to update news through social media It is faster to update news from social media rather than traditional media social media help to save cost for communication than using normal phone call I find social media useful for my job I feel safe when I use social media I think social media is easy to use I think message that people share on social media is useful I always find second source of information to support before I share anything on social media I believe in letter chain when people share on social media					

Table E Respondent's Demographic Profiles

	Frequency	Percent
Gender		
Female		
Male		
Education		
Lower than primary school		
Primary school		
High school		
Postgraduate		
Bachelor's degree		
Other		

	Frequency	Percent
Current occupation		
Full-time employed		
Part-time employed		
Housewife		
Retired		
Others		
Marital status		
Alone		
Live with family		
Others		
Children		
0		
1		
2		
3		
Grandchildren		
0		
1		

2		
3		
4 or above		
Household income per month		
Less than 15,000		
15,001-30,000		
30,001-50,000		
50,001-100,000		
More than 100,000		

